What a cosmetic can claim in Japan



Aidan McFarlane

The rules in numbers

56

Permitted claims for cosmetics

2011

Year the list was last expanded

Art. 66

Bans false or exaggerated claims, by anyone

Source: 厚生労働省 薬食発0721第1号 · 薬機法

Cosmetic or quasi-drug

	化粧品 Cosmetic	医薬部外品 Quasi-drug
Claims	Only the 56 on the list	Effects approved for that product
On pack	No special mark	Often 薬用
Example	Keeps skin moist	Suppresses melanin, prevents spots
To market	Notification	Product approval

Source: 厚生労働省 MHLW

Allowed and not allowed

Within the 56

肌にうるおいを与える
Moisturises the skin

肌の乾燥を防ぐ
Prevents dryness

乾燥による小ジワを目立たなくする
Makes fine lines from dryness less visible*

*Needs test data

Not allowed for cosmetics

~~治る~~
Cures

~~再生~~
Regenerates

~~デトックス~~
Detox

Source: 厚生労働省 ・ 都道府県 薬機法 広告指導

Before you translate your copy



Map Check every claim against the 56

Decide Cosmetic or quasi-drug, early

Brief Influencers are covered too

Review Japanese regulatory check on packs and ads

In Japan, the claim list is the brief.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

Aidan McFarlane · aidanmdesign.xyz

